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Independent work prepared for an application to Shanly Group. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Shanly.

APPLICATION FOR THE AI & BUSINESS SOLUTIONS GRADUATE ROLE

A small pilot that keeps every complaint date in view

Shanly Homes publishes a timetable for formal complaints: replies within 5, 10, 30 and 56 days, then at least every 28. I designed a small Microsoft 365 tool around it. It works out every date as soon as a complaint arrives, reminds the team before each one falls due, and has Copilot draft the letters for a person to approve.

The date rules are built and tested here. The SharePoint, Teams and Power Automate parts are designed and checked against Microsoft's published formats, but nothing has been installed in a live Microsoft 365 tenant.

SHORT ON TIME The three-minute route

15 SECONDS

1. The task

Keep every date in Shanly Homes' published complaints timetable in view, using Microsoft 365 and Copilot.

See the timetable

15 SECONDS

2. Where it stands

Built and tested: the date rules. Designed and validated, not yet installed in a live tenant: SharePoint, Teams and Power Automate.

What is not verified yet (https://growthforge.github.io/applications/shanly-m365-pilot/build-pack.html#for-it)

70 SECONDS

3. One complaint, followed through

An illustrative complaint arrives on Christmas Eve. Confirm it, watch the clock start after the bank holidays, go to the first reminder, then approve the letter.

Open the pilot

50 SECONDS

4. The evidence

Every date rule has its own passing test, every Microsoft file is validated against Microsoft's published schema, and the AI smoke test shows its failed first run.

The tests (https://growthforge.github.io/applications/shanly-m365-pilot/build-pack.html#engine)

The smoke test (https://growthforge.github.io/applications/shanly-m365-pilot/build-pack.html#smoke)

30 SECONDS

5. One past build

MTest Labs: an AI test-design tool that testers run themselves, with my part in it and the basis of its result stated.

Read the MTest Labs case

From your published process
The rules come from the customer care and New Homes Quality Code pages on shanlyhomes.com.

The simplest version first
One SharePoint list with the date formulas and one daily reminder in Teams. Everything else is optional.

Rules set the dates
Copilot only reads emails and drafts letters. It never picks a date or sends anything.

Day 0	**The clock starts** First working day after the complaint arrives	Day 5	**Acknowledge** Confirm the complaint is received	Day 10	**Proposed pathway** How it will be resolved, with timescales
Day 30	**Full assessment** The current position in full	Day 56	**Next steps** If it is not yet resolved	Then	**Every 28 days** Updates until it is concluded

Calendar days from the complaint initiation date, as set out on the Shanly Homes customer care page (read 3 November 2026).

SEVERAL EXAMPLES

What I have built, why, and how

Your advert asks to see what candidates have built, why and how. Each of these was taken up by the people it was built for. For the first two I also say what my part was and what each result rests on. Client systems are described, not shown; I would be glad to walk you through them in an interview.

MTEST LABS, A SOFTWARE-TESTING FIRM · AI BUILD, FROM DECEMBER 2025

An AI test-design tool the testers run themselves

WHY

Designing tests by hand took a full 8-hour day, or 2 to 3 days on larger projects.

HOW

A simple interface gathers the project documents and asks a short set of questions; staged AI agents then draft the scenarios and cases from the firm's own test library and past issue logs. A chat assistant lets the team ask questions of the firm's knowledge.

MY PART

An independent engagement. I designed and built the tool, its interface and the chat assistant, and refined them through build, test and improve cycles with the testers.

WHO ADOPTED IT

The testers. A tester approves every case before it reaches a client, and I trained the team to run it.

Test design now takes 1 to 3 supervised hours.

Basis of the result. The comparison is the time to design tests for a project: before, a full 8-hour day, or 2 to 3 days on larger projects; now, 1 to 3 hours of supervised draft-and-review, so the tester's review is inside the figure. These are my figures from the engagement; the client's records are not shown here.

ATELIER DI VENICE, AN INTERIOR-DESIGN BUSINESS · AUTOMATION, FROM DECEMBER 2025

One connected system, from first enquiry to delivery

WHY

Operations, marketing and finance steps were handled separately and by hand.

HOW

The business was mapped end to end, then the steps were automated through low-code automation and APIs, connecting tools it already had. A Power BI dashboard replaced a monthly pack that was rekeyed by hand. Low-risk steps run on their own; client and financial steps stay with a person.

MY PART

An independent engagement. I did the mapping, built the automations and the dashboard, and set where a person stays in the loop.

WHO ADOPTED IT

The owner, whom I trained to run it day to day.

Dozens of automated workflows, run by the owner.

Basis of the result. A count of the workflows automated across operations, marketing and finance, not a time or cost saving; none is claimed. The system belongs to the client, so it is described rather than shown.

BNK TO THE FUTURE, A REGULATED INVESTMENT PLATFORM · PROCESS REDESIGN, SEPTEMBER 2023 TO SEPTEMBER 2024

A simpler way to route, triage and escalate cases

WHY

Cases were slow to move, and the evidence behind each decision was inconsistent.

HOW

I simplified the process before automating any of it, set clear evidence standards, and created a template for each step.

WHO ADOPTED IT

Colleagues across the firm adopted the templates.

~25% faster turnaround across 100+ cases.

Two more, from earlier finance and operations roles

Kuruvella & Co., an accountancy practice. Excel dashboards and VBA macros for the monthly reporting pack across 30+ SME client entities, inside the tools the practice already used: ~35% less report preparation time.

AirTM, payments. SQL queries and live dashboards in place of manual tracking, with each fix written up as a standard procedure: ~30% backlog reduction, a 150-case backlog cleared in three weeks, and a 95%+ service level.

TRY IT

The pilot, in three steps

Pick an email, check the first read, log it, move the date forward to see a reminder, then approve the first letter. The examples are set around this coming Christmas to show how bank holidays move the clock. The first reads and drafts are my prompts' real output on these emails, from a smoke test on a stand-in model (Claude Haiku); in the pilot, Copilot does this step.

ILLUSTRATIVE DATA Fictional customers and developments. Nothing is sent.

Working here: the date rules, tested **Recorded:** the AI smoke test **Next:** installing it in Microsoft 365 with IT

Worked example

The email. Received on Thursday 24 December 2026 from a fictional customer at Plot 14, Orchard Rise (fictional): a repair agreed for four weeks has not been done, two visits were cancelled, and she asks for a formal complaint. She reserved on 9 January 2025 and completed on 27 June 2025.

What Copilot read. Formal complaint, high confidence, because of "Please treat this as a formal complaint". A coordinator confirms it.

Illustrative register row

Item	Date	Why
Clock starts	Tue 29 Dec 2026	Fri 25 Dec and Mon 28 Dec are bank holidays, with the weekend in between

Item	Date	Why
Acknowledge (day 5)	Sun 3 Jan 2027	Falls on a Sunday, so the suggested send-by date is Thu 31 Dec 2026
Proposed pathway (day 10)	Fri 8 Jan 2027	
Full assessment (day 30)	Thu 28 Jan 2027	
Next steps if unresolved (day 56)	Tue 23 Feb 2027	
Code	New Homes Quality Code, version 1	Reserved 9 Jan 2025
Two-year window	Until 27 Jun 2027	Two years from completion, the later date

The letter. Copilot drafts the acknowledgement; the register fills in "by Friday 8 January 2027" for the proposed pathway. A person ticks "I have read and checked this letter" before it can be approved and sent, and the approval is recorded.

WHY THIS PROCESS

Public rules, easy to check

I chose this process because its rules are public and precise enough to test against, not because anything needs fixing.

A formal complaint can be raised for two years from reservation or legal completion, whichever is later, and from day 56 a customer may refer it to the New Homes Ombudsman Service.

Three codes apply at once, chosen by the reservation date: the Consumer Code for Home Builders before 2 August 2023, version 1 of the New Homes Quality Code from 2 August 2023 to 1 March 2026, and version 2 from 2 March 2026. The register suggests the right one and a person confirms it.

> **What I do not know yet**
>
> How the Complaints Team logs complaints today, how many arrive, who signs the letters, and whether a register already exists. Aftercare items already run through Clixifix, which the business chose, and Clixifix also offers a complaints module, so some of this may already be covered. If so, the same method moves to the next process you choose.

Week one decides the route, with the Complaints Team

If we find	Then	Where the complaint record lives
Clixifix already tracks the dates and reminders well	Improve how it is configured and used; build nothing new	Clixifix
Clixifix holds the record, but reminders or letters still happen by hand	A small flow on top of the existing record	Clixifix, read by the flow
No register exists, or the gap is real	This pilot, with a named owner and a rule against duplicate records	The SharePoint register

How it would run

A complaint arrives in the shared mailbox
Outlook

A coordinator confirms the type and dates on a Teams card
Power Automate and Teams

The register works out every due date by formula
SharePoint list

A daily reminder goes out two working days before each date
Power Automate and Teams

Copilot drafts the letter; a person approves and sends it
Copilot in Outlook or Copilot Chat, Approvals

Questions I would expect from IT

- **Licensing:** standard connectors only (Outlook, SharePoint, Teams, Approvals). The automated AI step is a later option, after a licensing check.
- **Ownership:** a service account with at least two co-owners, in a solution outside the default environment.
- **Failure:** run-failure alerts, plus a short daily "clock ran" message so a missed day is obvious.
- **Personal data:** stays in the tenant; the register is restricted to the Complaints Team; retention agreed with your data protection lead, and a DPIA before any automated AI step.
- **Upkeep and exit:** a yearly bank-holiday refresh from GOV.UK; turn the flows off and the team carries on by hand.

The build pack and the handover note (https://growthforge.github.io/applications/shanly-m365-pilot/build-pack.html#for-it)

HOW I WENT ABOUT IT

Rules first, then AI where it helps

- **The rules became tests before anything else:** Shanly Homes' own examples, Easter, Christmas, the code boundaries and the two-year window. Every test passes.
- **Dates by formula:** due dates are SharePoint formulas anyone can read; AI only reads emails and drafts letters.
- **Prompts checked before suggesting them:** a smoke test on illustrative emails written separately from the prompt. The first run failed because the prompt left out three fields; both runs are in the build pack.
- **Agent-led build, checked at every step:** as on client work, I directed AI coding agents (Claude Code) and made the checks part of the build, so every date rule has its own test and every Microsoft file is validated automatically before anyone relies on it. The results are in the build pack.
- **If you choose this,** I would start by spending time with the Complaints Team to see how complaints are handled today, then trial it alongside the current process.

Contact

In an interview I can run the pilot, explain the date rules line by line, and build the intake step in Power Automate with you. I would also like to hear which process the Group would most like to make simpler first.

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Prepared by Hemanth Vallamkonda as part of an application to Shanly Group. Independent and illustrative; uses public information only.

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